THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 7 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 6: **The Rise of Empires** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A historian compares Megasthenes' and Kautilya's accounts of Pataliputra. This is useful because 1

(a) independent sources can confirm or challenge each other
(b) both are identical
(c) both are modern
(d) neither is relevant

2. The Lion Capital at Sarnath was chosen as India's emblem because 1

(a) it was a flag
(b) it symbolises strength, courage and dhamma
(c) it was a coin
(d) it was a weapon

3. Which of the following is a risk of relying only on Indica? 1

(a) it is an inscription
(b) it is a Mauryan record
(c) Greek ambassador may misunderstand customs
(d) it is always accurate

4. Which of the following shows the moral side of Ashoka's rule? 1

(a) edicts urging tolerance and care for all **(b)** a large army
(c) border forts **(d)** tax rise

5. What best explains why guild records survive on inscriptions? 1

(a) they banned writing **(b)** guilds made donations and were recorded
(c) they had no money **(d)** they were illegal

6. Which of these best illustrates cultural exchange in Mauryan times? 1

(a) no contact **(b)** Greek and Indian art and ideas meeting
(c) no art **(d)** no trade

7. If the edicts are found from Kandahar to Karnataka, this shows 1

(a) a trade fair **(b)** the weakness of Ashoka
(c) the vast extent of Ashoka's empire **(d)** his travel only

8. Why is Chandragupta's contact with Seleucus important? 1

(a) it ended trade
(b) it ended the empire
(c) it started war
(d) it settled borders and began diplomatic ties

9. **Assertion (A):** The Ashoka Chakra on the Indian flag has 24 spokes. 1
Reason (R): The chakra is a wheel of dharma taken from an Ashokan pillar.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** Ashoka gave up war after the Kalinga war. 1
Reason (R): He felt remorse at the suffering caused by the war.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why are edicts reliable evidence? 2

12. What can the Sohgaura plate tell us? 2

13. Why did the Mauryas use polished stone? 2

14. Why did Ashoka choose public places for edicts? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate the sources for the Mauryas and their reliability. 3

16. Assess the impact of Alexander's invasion on Indian politics. 3

17. Examine how Ashoka's edicts reveal his personality. 3

OR

Analyse why Ashoka's policy of dhamma was both moral and political. 3

18. Analyse why symbols of Ashoka were adopted by modern India. 3

OR

Discuss how the Mauryans dealt with diversity. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** Around 321 BCE, Chandragupta Maurya, guided by his teacher Chanakya (Kautilya), overthrew the last Nanda king and took control of Magadha. He later built a large empire with Pataliputra as its capital. 5
(i) Who was the last Nanda king?
(ii) Who founded the Maurya Empire?
(iii) What was the capital of the Mauryas?
(iv) Why was Magadha a good base to build an empire?

20. Evaluate Ashoka's dhamma as a political and moral strategy. 5

OR

Assess the legacy of the Mauryas for modern India. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks